minister. Defence minister of Myanmar quoted the word of defence minister of UK. He says, ‘Without good economy … strong defence is not possible’.[138]

The regime’s logic, and its vulnerability, is clear. It wants a strong economy so that it can act as it wants without fear of external pressure.[139] The current regime does not want economic growth to benefit the bulk of Myanmar’s people. Nevertheless, it might be prepared to recognise the Rohingyas if it believes this is needed to secure economic growth.[140] It is aware of external debates, and the need to at least avoid open conflict with external powers. As one Rohingya activist put it, ‘if we stop international pressure, they will relax. So at the one side, international pressure should continue, I fully agree with that’.[141] As I will argue later in this book, at the moment the international community has more leverage over the regime than it seems prepared to use. This indifference may well have fatal results.